



PERMA NEWSLETTER

FOREWORD FROM THE PRESIDENT, DATO A. GNANARAJAH

This pandemic's impact is tilted towards the most vulnerable, affecting low income households across all sectors. PERMA met their immediate needs, funded through donations given by members, friends of PERMA, as well as Corporate Sponsors. On behalf of all PERMA members and the Committee, I wish to extend our deepest appreciation to all donors and sponsors. We are also grateful to our Service Partners who assisted with the execution of several projects.

1.SAREE RUN - NOVEMBER 2020

Ms Rupa Sivanoli and Dr Bharathi Vengadasalam organised an innovative and inaugural 5km charity saree run.

PERMA's President, Dato Gnanarajah and Deputy President Mr Chakaravarthy flagged off the 8 runners including Ms Indira and Ms Sumithra from PERMA. Many supporters were present to cheer the runners and added to the gaiety of this marvellous event. In the final tally, the runners had handsomely surpassed their initial target of RM10,000 and had raised RM 18,510. PERMA is indeed most appreciative and thankful for this kind gesture.

PERMA will apply these funds towards acquiring tablets to support children from B40 backgrounds. Recently PERMA launched a public appeal to raise further funds to acquire a total of 100 tablets for this worthy project.



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2. RENTAL ASSISTANCE FOR A WIDOW NOVEMBER 2020

A widow had become destitute after being swindled and was threatened with eviction from her flat in Kajang. To alleviate her plight, Ms Visahini from PERMA had secured a donation of RM3,600 from her law firm, Messrs Ellison Wong. The donation covered rental payment for 6 months with effect from November 2020. The purpose of this assistance was to allow a grace period for the distressed lady to identify an alternate and sustainable accommodation arrangement.

3. DEEPAVALI CHEER- NOVEMBER 2020

PERMA is grateful to BAC's "Give Back" crowd funding platform to raise funds to bring some Deepavali cheer to the needy during this MCO blighted festive season. A total of RM 10,233.25 was donated by well wishers for this project. The Sri Agathiar Sanmarka Sangam in Dengkil, Selangor, had identified 20 single mothers. PERMA gave them RM100 each at a total cost of RM2,000.

In addition, PERMA also gave goodie bags and RM10 cash gift to 81 children from B 40 families in Klang. The goodie bags were filled with confectionery, stationary sets and examination pads for the older children at a total cost of RM 4,050. Apexian Phillip Andrews distributed the goodies and cash gifts to the 81 children in the vicinity. PERMA will apply the remaining balance of RM 4,183 to similar worthy projects in the near future.

4. DONATION TO SJK(T) LADANG KERLING SCHOOL - DECEMBER 2020

Ms Indira from PERMA had arranged for computers, office equipment and furniture from a business owner to be donated to SJK(T) Ladang Kerling. The items included 6 Dell computers, 2 television sets, 2 armchairs, 2 tables with 12 chairs, small cabinets and 2 air-conditioners worth RM14,000. These items are being used by this remotely located Tamil school to furnish the school's resource learning centre and staff room.





5. CHRISTMAS CHEER 2020 FOR 304 CHILDREN

PERMA once again used BAC 'Give Back' platform to raise funds to bring joy to the underprivileged children. Many donors had kindly responded. In addition, PERMA's President, Dato Gnanarajah, Deputy President Mr Chakaravarthy, Committee members

Ms Visahini and Ms Sumithra truly rose to the occasion to tap on their respective network to raise considerable donations. A whopping RM 32,981 was collected. Ms Indira from PERMA had then meticulously identified and sourced appropriate gifts for each age group.

In addition, each child received a goodie bag packed with dark chocolate chips, cookies, Pringles, Kit Kat Chocolates, Munchy oat raisin cookies, strawberry wafers and Gingerbread cookies. Meanwhile, each of these Centres were given Alphabet sets, wooden blocks play sets, Roald Dahl booksets, Malay language booksets, a football, a volleyball, original Hasbro Twister game, Congkak, Foosball, Frisbees, Connect - 4, Rimba card games, art sets and a large fruitcake.

1. Lighthouse, Bangsar -63 kids- Mr Cakara/Pushpa
2. Sri Lankan Refugees, Sentul -33 kids- Vicks/Mangales/ Sar
3. Praise Emmanuel, Section 6, Pj - 6 kids - Vim/Visa
4. Trinity Homes, Section 7 - 20 kids - Vim/Visa
5. Home of Peace, Old Klang Road - 17 kids - Vim/Visa
6. Sri Bala- Batu Caves - 30 kids- Indira/ Sumi
7. Destiny Starting Point, Klang-50 kids- BAC
8. Refuge for Refugees, Bandar Sunway-26 kids- BAC
9. Rumah Jaireh, Batu Arang - 4 kids- BAC
10. Mary's Orphanage, Setapak - 55 kids - Laili/ Jayanthi

The presents were individually packed and tagged with each child's name for a personal touch. The distributions were carried out by 9 teams comprising of PERMA's committee members plus volunteers from BAC. The joy of Christmas was seen through the smiles of the children.





6. FLOOD RELIEF - JANUARY 2021

The monsoon was ferocious and large swathes of the country was inundated, causing severe hardships for many. Mr Rajasingam from BAC and his team of volunteers immediately responded and drove to Mentakab to provide aid to the flood victims. PERMA donated toiletries sponsored by Colgate Palmolive Malaysia, for these victims.

Separately, on 21 January 2021, FOMSO organised a project to bring relief to 50 Indian families who were marooned in estates in the Bentong and Karak Districts. PERMA supported this initiative by donating groceries for 20 families at the cost of RM1,872.00

FOMSO had arranged with the Malaysian Red Crescent to effect the deliveries and PERMA shared the transportation cost with FOMSO.

7. CHINESE NEW YEAR PROJECT 2021

The Sri Agathiar Sanmarka Sangam identified 100 Chinese families in the Dengkil area who live in abject poverty and faced a bleak Chinese New Year. The MCO lock down compounded their misery as they were unable to work. PERMA's committee immediately approved the purchase of 100 rice bags and cartons of Mandarin oranges for distribution to these families to bring a spark of joy during the festive period. The Sangam distributed the rice and oranges, together with other essentials donated by another NGO

8. DONATION OF TABLES TO SJK (T) LADANG KERLING - MARCH 2021

The headmaster of this Tamil school in Hulu Selangor had requested for 8 foldable rectangular tables. PERMA donated these tables which cost RM 1,080 and the tables were delivered to the school on 8 March 2021.





9. GROCERIES FOR 300 VISUALLY HANDICAPPED FAMILIES BY YAYASAN SIME DARBY - MARCH 2021

The Yayasan Sime Darby collaborated with PERMA to provide groceries worth a total of RM30,000 to 300 visually handicapped families, registered with the Malaysian Association of the Blind (MAB).

Dato Kulasegaran the former Deputy President of MAB and FOMSO's President, Mr Charles Chew the serving Vice President of MAB, Dato Gnanarajah PERMA's President, together with several PERMA Committee members were present on 9 March 2021 to receive YSD's donation and then to pack the 300 individual parcels. Over the next few days, PERMA committee members were present to distribute the groceries to the 300 families.





10. FEED THE STRAYS PROJECT - MARCH 2021

Kind donors had donated a total of RM 4,100 to PERMA to feed stray dogs during the MCO lock down. PERMA had contributed RM 2,000 for this project. Hence the total funds available for this project was RM 6,100.

Phase 1 was completed in March 2021 when PERMA donated RM 1,835 worth of 15 x 20kg dog kibbles and 10x10 kg rice bags to Mr Veeraya who feeds stray dogs daily. Ms Indira and Ms Sumithra from PERMA had travelled to Batu Caves to help feed the stray dogs.

Phase 2 was completed in August 2021. PERMA supplied rice bags and dog kibbles worth RM 2,027 to the Malaysian Independent Animal Rescue (MIAR)

The balance RM 2,238 will be disbursed at a subsequent date when a similar worthy project is identified.





11. SPONSORSHIP OF 25 STUDENTS AT VTOC, YWCA - JUNE 2021

PERMA is committed to supporting education and skills training as they provide effective pathways for upward socio-economic mobility for children from

B40 families. PERMA has supported girls pursuing vocational courses in tailoring, culinary skills, beauty and hair styling at the Vocational Training Opportunity Centre (VTOC) run by YMCA. For the 2021 cohort, PERMA provided 15 girls with a monthly stipend of RM 50 per student with effect from April 2021. There was a further appeal for 10 more students. Ms Indira from PERMA secured a sponsor for these additional 10 girls who received their stipend with effect from June 2021. The total sum spent for these 25 VTOC students was RM8,700.

PERMA is delighted to note that several of the past graduates who were sponsored by PERMA are now earning reasonable incomes.



12. GROCERIES FOR SHANDAI ORPHANAGE - June 2021

The Shandai orphanage provides a loving atmosphere for children who were abandoned by their parents or who come from broken homes. Some of the children are disabled, and the youngest was only 6 months. PERMA responded to this Home's appeal and Ms Visahini obtained a sponsor for RM1,000 to provide groceries to this orphanage for 2 months.





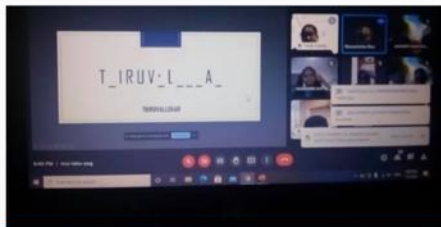
13. STATIONERY FOR A COMMUNITY LEARNING CENTRE - JUNE 2021

The Yayasan Sunbeam Home in Ampang runs a community learning centre for abused and displaced young children. The total cost for 6 months of stationery requirements was RM 1,600. PERMA's Deputy President, Mr Chakaravarthy and his band of kind hearted friends wholly funded this cost. The stationery stocks were delivered to this Centre on 20 June 2021.



14. LAPTOP FOR A TEACHER - JULY 2021

PERMA collaborated with Medical Awareness Camp Outreach (MACO) to provide a HP laptop to Ms Thenmoli. She provides religious and thevaram classes.



15. Food provisions for 100 families July 2021

PERMA provided RM 8,945 worth of dry provisions for 100 families living in Dengkil. Ms Vimala, Welfare Chairperson from PERMA coordinated this project.





16. "ANATHANAM" WITH ANNALAKSHMI HOT MEALS FOR 800 STREET PEOPLE - JULY/AUGUST 2021

Annalakshmi Restaurant of the Temple of Fine Arts provided 800 delicious cooked meals at RM 5 per meal. These meals were delivered to those reduced to living on the streets, located in the vicinity of Central Market, near the Ganesha Temple in Puduraya, Masjid India neighbourhood and Pudu. Ms Sumithra from PERMA brought in RM2,000 from sponsors and PERMA matched these donations with a further RM 2,000. These meals were delivered in batches over several days in July and August 2021.



17. MAKAN KONGSI PROJECT TO FEED THE HUNGRY - JULY, AUGUST 2021

The NGO, 'Makan KongsI' gave a grant of RM 8,000 to PERMA. Ms Indra from PERMA had successfully obtained this grant. The total cost of groceries for these 130 families came up to RM 9,800. PERMA topped up the grant with RM 1,800. Ms Sumithra from PERMA collaborated with the NGOs, namely, Kechara Soup Kitchen, Fugee and Dignity for Children who identified 130 needy families. The families were located in Gombak, Setapak, Batu Caves, Sentul, Kepong, Belakong, Ampang, Selayang and in Petaling Jaya. The deliveries to these families were effected from 27 July to 6 August 2021.



18. FOOD AID FOR 41 FAMILIES- AUGUST 2021

The Sai Baba Center had identified 41 families in Ampang, Serendah, Subang and Batang Kali. Ms Pushpa from PERMA worked with Sai Baba to assist the 41 families. Groceries were delivered to these families on 21st and 22nd August, 2021. The total cost was RM 2,944.20.

19. TABLETS AND DATA FOR 18 STUDENTS AUGUST 2021

The Headmistress of SJK (T) Batu Caves appealed for tablets for 18 students from marginalised families. These students had no access to online classes during the pandemic. Following this appeal, PERMA raised RM18,559 which covered the cost of 18 tablets and data for 1 year. The school's leadership and PIBG regularly monitor the students' use of the tablets and data.



20. ACER LAPTOP FOR A STUDENT -November 2021

Sharun is an excellent student, presently studying matriculation at Kolej Matrikulasi Kelantan. Sharun had been using his mobile phone for classes and sharing his parents data.

The Acer Swift 5 laptop costing RM3,570 was presented to his parents by PERMA's president, Dato Gnanarajah. This laptop should hopefully serve Sharun in good stead until he completes his degree.





21. GROCERIES FOR 621 FAMILIES BY YAYASAN SIME DARBY (YSD) OCTOBER 2021

PERMA is honoured that YSD had positively responded to PERMA's request for a donation of dry provisions to feed 621 families in need. This is YSD's third collaboration with PERMA and Ms Visahini, a Committee member successfully obtained the sponsorship.

YSD provided RM 45,000 worth of groceries and hygiene items which were delivered to the Malaysian Ceylonese National Community Center (MCNCC) on 18 October 2021. PERMA's members namely Indira, Sumithra and Visahini were on hand to receive and check the consignments. On the 19 October 2021, many of PERMA'S committee members and other volunteers arduously packed the 621 individual parcels.

The deliveries were then effected to the following recipients.

- *117 Afghan refugees,
- *36 families located in Ladang Vallambrosa, Kapar,
- *60 families located in Ladang Nigel Gardener, Batang Berjuntai,
- *71 families through Yayasan Sunbeam,
- *68 families through HEI
- *100 families through Geutanyou Foundation,
- *91 families through an Apex Club,
- *30 families in Taman Sentosa, and
- *50 families through the Ganesha Temple in PJ.





AGM 2020



The Movement Control Order to suppress the COVID19 pandemic prohibited any physical meeting. Consequently, PERMA held its first virtual AGM via Zoom. A record 78 members attended.

President Dato Gnanarajah gave his opening address. Ms Vimala, Welfare Chairperson and Ms Sumithra, a committee member presented a full report of all the PERMA projects. Treasurer, Mr Seelan Chelliah, presented PERMA's audited financial statements and responded to questions.

The President, Dato Gnanarajah, said that 2020 will always be remembered as a calamitous year when the COVID19 pandemic struck hard, triggering a nationwide lockdown. This resulted in devastating economic consequences for the low income groups across all sectors. PERMA brought relief through several projects that were identified and successfully implemented even when the dangers of the Covid contagion were raging at its height. The details of these projects have been reported in PERMA's October 2020 Newsletter.

The President commended the committee for its excellent teamwork bringing PERMA to greater heights. Dato Gnanarajah then announced the Inaugural President's Meritorious Awards. He said for the year 2020, the recipients through their collective effort had brought much happiness and cheer to the underprivileged in their hour of desperate need. The recipients were Mr Chakaravarthy, Ms Indira, Ms Visahini and Ms Sumithra.

Dato Gnanarajah presented these recipients with an engraved pen set as a token of appreciation at PERMA's physical Committee meeting held on 31 March 2021.



SERVICE PARTNERS
who have joined hands with PERMA to help rebuild lives and livelihoods to ease the burden of those severely impacted by COVID19's economic fallout.

SPONSORS



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